GREATER AKRON CHAMBER

Admin & MC Trade Guide

Installing and running the scanner, AI double-check, duplicates and exports, the MC Trade import, accounts, settings, privacy, troubleshooting.

Pilot guide · updated Oct 14, 2026 · version 0.2.0 (round 17)

Greater Akron Chamber · business-card scanner pilot · internal use only

Pilot guide, updated Oct 14, 2026 (version 0.2.0, round 17). It covers installing and running the scanner, exporting, the MC Trade import, admin tasks, privacy, troubleshooting and FAQs. **Reviewers: start with the Reviewer Start Here guide. Open the printable PDF**. All screenshots use made-up demo cards (fictional people, 555 phone numbers).

Contents

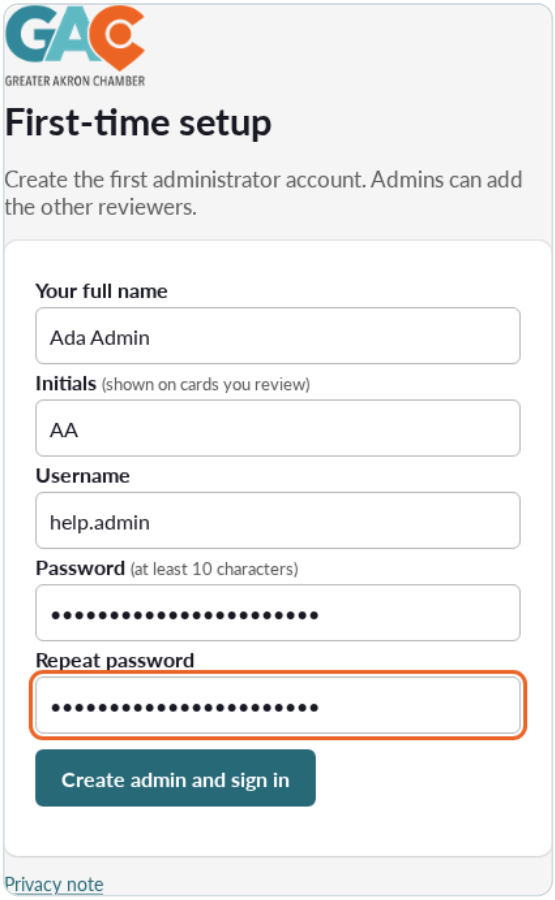
- 2. Starting the scanner
- 7. AI double-check suggestions
- 8. Duplicates
- 10. Exporting
- 11. MC Trade import: day-one steps
- 12. Admin tasks
- 13. Privacy and removal requests
- 14. Troubleshooting
- 15. Frequently asked questions
- 16. Quick reference

2. Starting the scanner

This part is for the person who looks after the scanner computer.

2.1 First-time installation (once, about 15 minutes)

1. **Install Python 3** from https://www.python.org/downloads/. On Windows, tick **"Add python.exe to PATH"** in the installer.
2. **Install Tesseract**, the card-reading engine:
    - **Mac:** install Homebrew (https://brew.sh), then type `brew install tesseract` in Terminal.
    - **Windows:** run the installer from https://github.com/UB-Mannheim/tesseract/wiki and keep the default folder.
3. Unzip **gac-card-scanner-pilot.zip** somewhere permanent, for example *Documents*.
4. Double-click **`start.command`** (Mac) or **`start.bat`** (Windows). The first start installs components and takes a few minutes.
    - Mac: if it says the file "can't be opened", right-click it, choose **Open**, then **Open** again.
5. Your browser opens **http://localhost:8765/ui**. The first time it shows **First-time setup**: type your full name, initials, a username and a password (at least 10 characters) twice, then click **Create admin and sign in**.
    - First-time setup only works on the scanner computer itself, not from another computer or a phone.



First-time setup creates the first admin account.

6. Go to **Admin → Reviewers** and add an account for each person on the data team (section 12.1).

2.2 Every day

1. Double-click `start.command` / `start.bat`. It takes about 10 seconds. If the scanner is already running, it just opens the browser.
2. **Keep the black window open** while anyone is working. Closing it stops the scanner for everyone.
3. The address is **http://localhost:8765** on the scanner computer.

> **Note:** the black window says whether the AI double-check is online. If it says **"AI checker OFFLINE"**, scanning still works; section 7.5.

2.3 Optional: the AI double-check

The AI double-check needs extra model files (about 3 GB). They are **not** in the zip and **not** in the Windows/Mac installers.

- **Desktop app (installer):** an admin opens **Admin → Settings → AI helper** and clicks **Download AI helper (3 GB)**. A progress bar shows the download; then **Start AI helper** / **Stop AI helper** / **Remove AI helper**. It runs only on this computer. Skip it if the computer is short of disk space or memory: scanning works without it.

- **Zip / server version:** if IT has set up the model files, double-click `start-ai-checker.command` in a second window and leave it open too. Without it, cards are only read the fast way and nothing else changes.

2.4 Optional: phone access

Phones can scan cards with their camera over the office Wi-Fi. Nothing needs to be set up first:

1. In the scanner, open **Scan cards** and choose **Scan with phone**. A QR code appears.
2. Scan it with the phone (same office Wi-Fi). The phone opens a page for this batch only; the link works once and expires after 15 minutes.
3. Windows may ask about the firewall the first time: allow **Private networks** only (port 8766).

The old `enable-phone-access` scripts are retired. Phone mode does **not** work when the scanner runs in Docker as shipped (the phone port isn't published and the container's address isn't the computer's); use the normal start scripts for phone scanning.

2.5 Stopping and backing up

- **Stop:** close the black window.
- **Automatic backup:** while it runs, the scanner makes a backup **every night at 02:30** (or soon after it starts, if the computer was off at night) and **keeps the last 7**. Each backup is one file, `backups/gac-backup-<date>-<time>.tgz`, with the database (copied safely while running), card photos, stored exports and the template. The MC Trade contacts export is **never** in a backup. To keep backups on another disk (recommended: a USB drive or a synced folder), start the scanner with `GAC_BACKUP_DIR` set to that folder. Make one now with `scripts/backup.sh`.
- **Restore:** stop the scanner, then run `scripts/restore_backup.sh` to list the backups and `scripts/restore_backup.sh backups/gac-backup-….tgz` to restore one (type YES). The backup is checked first; the current `data` folder is moved aside to `data.before-restore-<time>` (nothing is deleted) and the uploaded MC Trade contacts file is kept. Start the scanner again afterwards.
- Keep backups no longer than 30 days and store them as securely as the computer itself.

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7. AI double-check suggestions

> **Spelling/typo double-check, advisory only: compare every field to the photo.** The AI catches some misread letters and digits, but it often misses wrong words, a wrong job title or a missing state/zip. "No changes needed" does **not** mean the card is right. Rule-based checks (e.g. *Rnbber → Rubber*, *Akrn → Akron*, an email domain that doesn't match the website) appear as separate suggestions.

7.1 What it is

> **Two separate steps (round 15).** 1) **Reading the photos**: the progress on the *Scan cards* page ("about N min left"). When a card shows "Added", it is already in the Review queue. 2) **The AI double-check**: the optional, later spelling check. The header badge **"AI: N cards · all done in ~M min"** counts *everyone's* cards waiting for this second step. You don't need to wait for it: review and approve now (approving cancels a card's waiting check). Hover the badge for this explanation. When no card is waiting, the badge says **AI check: on**, **AI check: off** or **AI check: on, but not running**, for everyone including reviewers (hover it for what that means; only an admin can switch it, in Admin → Settings).

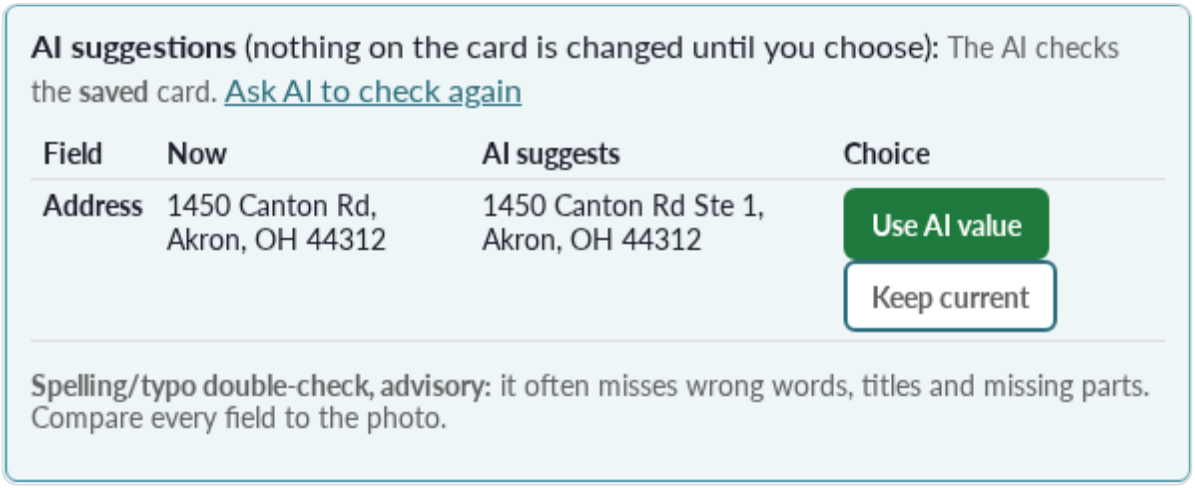
When a card was hard to read, a small AI model running **on the scanner computer** re-reads it in the background. It **never changes the card by itself**. It offers **suggestions** you accept or ignore. Cards a person has already edited or decided are never changed. Nothing leaves the computer.

7.2 What you see

On the card	Meaning
AI checking…	The check is running or waiting in line. Keep working; you don't need to wait for it to approve. It can take a minute or more per card. Cards take turns.
AI busy	The model is busy with other cards. After 30 minutes of waiting the check is skipped.
AI check failed, retrying	The AI checker couldn't be reached. The scanner tries again by itself up to 3 times (after 1, 2 and 3 minutes) and updates the label. You can still review and approve.
AI suggestions	It found differences. Choose for each one (below).
AI-checked	Finished; *no changes needed*, or the corrections you accepted are listed.
AI double-check skipped	For example *a person reviewed this card first*, or it didn't finish in time. The card is fine to review as it is.

7.3 Using the suggestions

1. Open the card. The blue **AI suggestions** box lists each field: what the card says **Now**, and what the **AI suggests**.
2. For each row click **Use AI value** (puts the AI's value into the field) or **Keep current**.
3. Check the field against the photo, then **Save** / **Approve** as usual.



An AI suggestion for the Address field. (In this demo the AI is a stand-in that always adds "Ste 1"; the real model suggests real corrections.)

- **Ask AI to double-check** (or *Ask AI to check again*) asks for a fresh check of this card. The AI checks the **saved** card, so click **Save changes** first if you've typed anything.
- Approved, rejected and exported cards are skipped automatically.

7.4 Turning it on or off

Admins: **Admin → Settings → AI double-check: on/off**. Ticked = on, unticked = off. When it is **off**, no AI checks run at all, including the *Ask the AI* button. The line underneath says whether the model is running.

At events, switch it off unless the AI checker runs on its **own, dedicated machine**. It checks one card at a time, at about 45–170 seconds per card on the scanner computer, and it slows the scanner down while it works. Scanning, review and export don't need it. Its suggestions are advisory only.

When it is on, the line is shared fairly: each person's cards take turns, and within one person's cards the oldest goes first. Approving or rejecting a card cancels only that card's own waiting check.

7.5 If the AI checker is offline

The scanner works normally without it; cards are just read the fast way. Signs that it's offline: the black window says **"AI checker OFFLINE"**, and Admin → Settings says *"The AI model is not running right now"*. To start it, double-click `start-ai-checker.command` on the scanner computer (if IT installed the model files). If that window says *"No models folder found"* or *"Model file ... not found"*, ask IT; there is nothing to fix in the scanner itself.

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8. Duplicates

The scanner looks for two kinds of possible duplicate and gives you plain-language choices in an **orange box** on the review screen.

8.1 Same person as another scanned card

a) In the same batch, or the same photo ("duplicate scan")

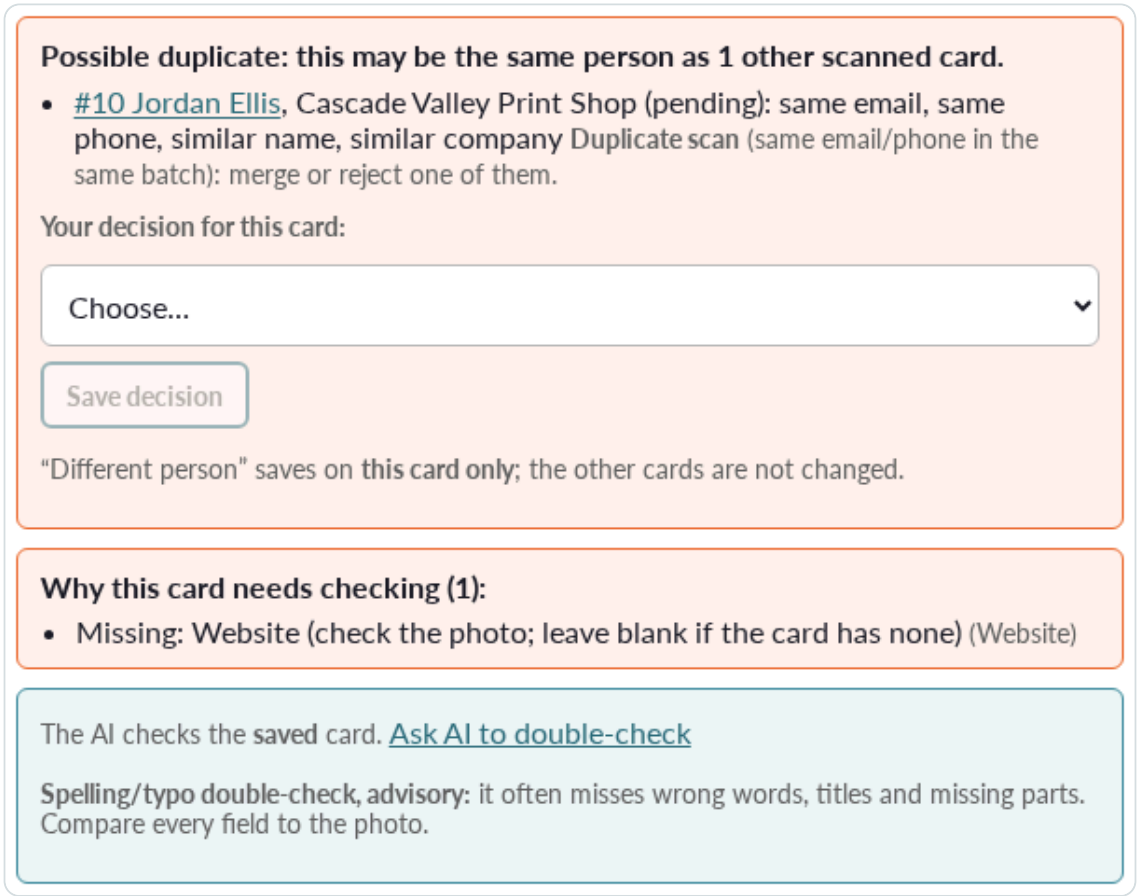
The same email or phone **in the same batch** is treated as a **duplicate scan**. It **blocks approval** until you deal with it, and you can't keep both. Scanning the exact same photo again **into the same batch** is refused at upload.

The same photo in **another person's or another batch** is only a **warning**: it's listed first in the look-alike box, and you decide like any other look-alike (b).

Use **Your decision for this card** (a drop-down, grouped *In this batch* / *Earlier batches* / *Not the same person*), then click **Save decision**:

- Choose **Same person as #X …: add any new details to #X and drop this card**. Any extra email or phone is copied into card #X, and this card is rejected as a duplicate. **or**
- Reject one of the two cards.

After a reject: once one of the two cards is rejected (for example with *Reject selected*), the other no longer blocks. It still shows the hint **"May be the same person as card #N (rejected, this batch): a hint only, it doesn't block"**, in the queue and under *Why this card needs checking*, so you can check that the right card was kept. Look-alikes in other batches are on their own line, *"Looks like card … (another batch)"*. Long lists show the first 10, then *"…and N more"*.



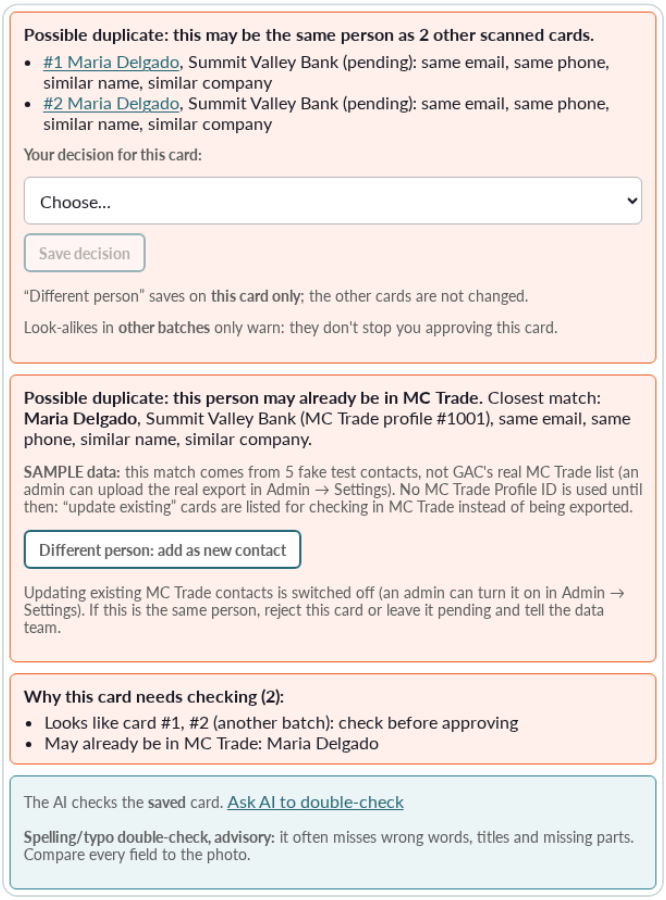
Two photos of Jordan Ellis's card in one batch: "Duplicate scan (same email/phone in the same batch): merge or reject one of them."

b) A look-alike in another batch

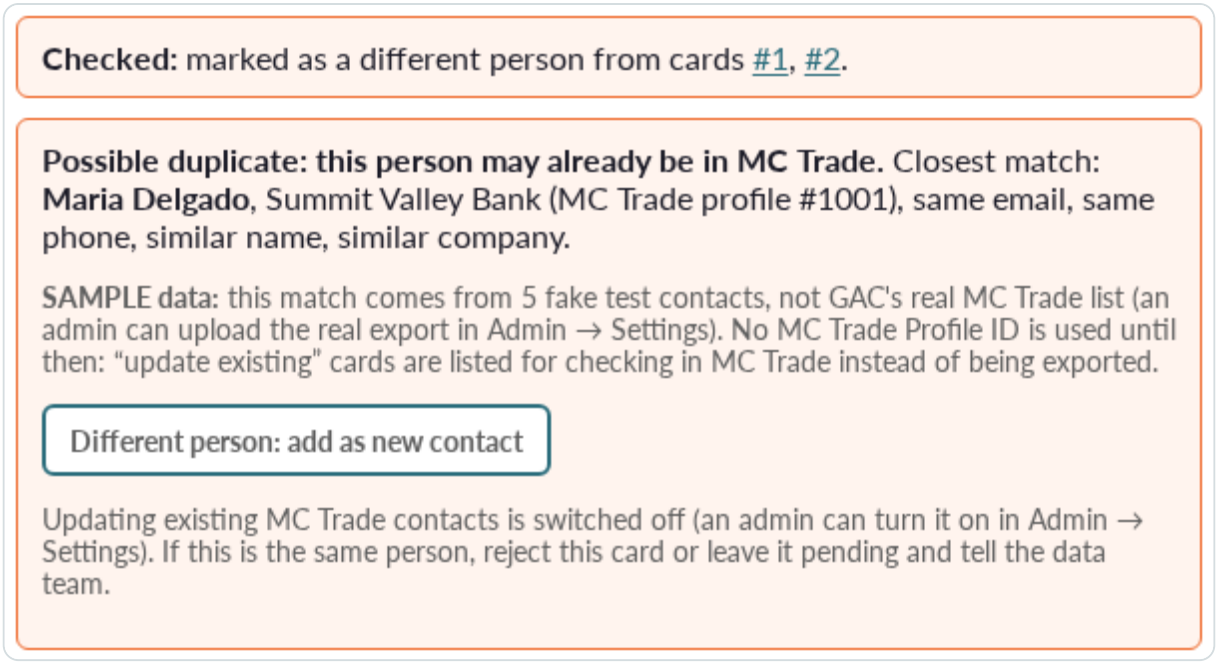
For example, someone gave you their card at two different events. This **only warns**; it doesn't stop you approving.

- **Same person as #X …: add any new details to #X and drop this card**, or
- **Different person from all N listed cards: keep both** (under *Not the same person*), which marks every listed look-alike as a different person from this card in one click (and records that you confirmed it).

If one of the look-alikes is **already approved** in another batch with the same email or phone, **Approve** asks first: *"Same person already approved in another batch?"* with **Open that card**, **Different person: approve this one too**, or **Cancel**. **Approve selected** in the queue approves such cards too, but its summary lists each one with a warning, and lists every card it skipped and why.



Maria Delgado also appears in other batches (other events). "Different person from all … listed cards: keep both" settles every listed look-alike at once.



After "keep both": "Checked: marked as a different person from cards …".

> **Careful:** only choose *Different person … keep both* when you're sure. If they really are the same person, merge instead; otherwise the person may be imported twice.

8.2 May already be in MC Trade

The box says **"Possible duplicate: this person may already be in MC Trade"** and names the closest match and why (same email, same phone, similar name…).

- **Same person: update their existing MC Trade contact.** The card goes into the separate **…-UPDATES.xlsx** file, with the MC Trade Profile ID.
- **Different person: add as new contact.** The card goes into the normal new-profiles file. If its email is exactly the same as an existing MC Trade contact, it is still added, but the READ-ME and the extra-columns CSV list it under **NEEDS REVIEW** so the importer checks it first.

> **"Update existing" is switched off by default.** An admin turns it on under Admin → Settings once GAC's real MC Trade contacts export has been uploaded (section 11) and one update import was tested. While it is off, only **add as new contact** is offered.

Your choice is shown as *Decision: …* with a **Change** link, and is written in the export's **MCTradeAction** column.

> **Important for the pilot:** until an admin uploads GAC's real MC Trade contacts export (Admin → Settings → *MC Trade contacts*), "already in MC Trade" is checked against a **SAMPLE** list of 5 fake contacts, and the box says **SAMPLE**. Sample matches are examples only: the scanner **never writes a Profile ID** from them, and a card marked *update existing* is listed as **POSSIBLE EXISTING MEMBER** in the READ-ME instead of going into any import file. **A card whose email matches a SAMPLE contact is still exported as a new profile** (it is NOT held back, because the sample is fake); only with GAC's real contacts loaded would it be NEEDS REVIEW. The SAMPLE box is shown on the card however you open it (from the queue, with Prev/Next, or from a link).

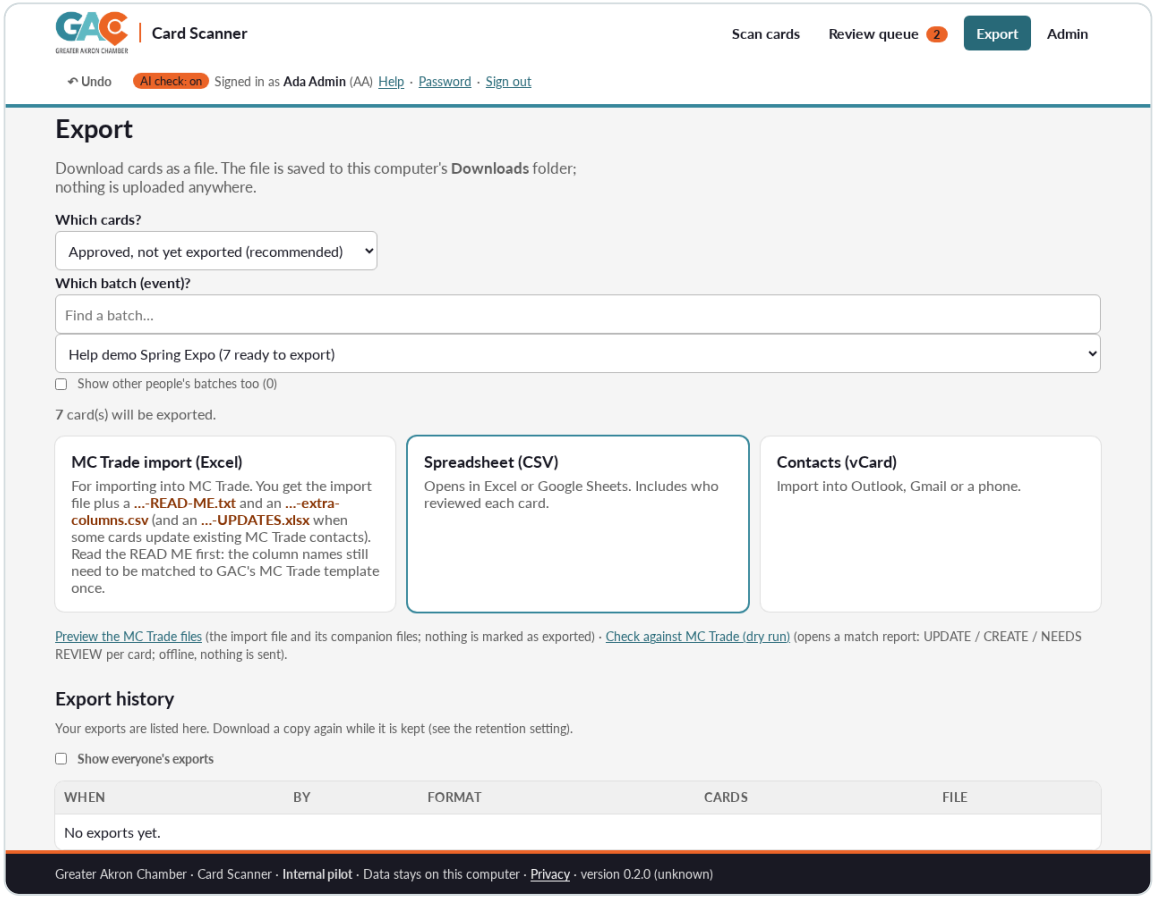
8.3 Duplicates and exports

An export is **blocked** while two cards in it look like the same person, so nobody is imported twice. The Export page shows a short **review list** (open the *Look-alikes to settle* section): open each card and merge it or mark it as a different person. Admins also see **Mark all as different people**, which asks first.

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10. Exporting

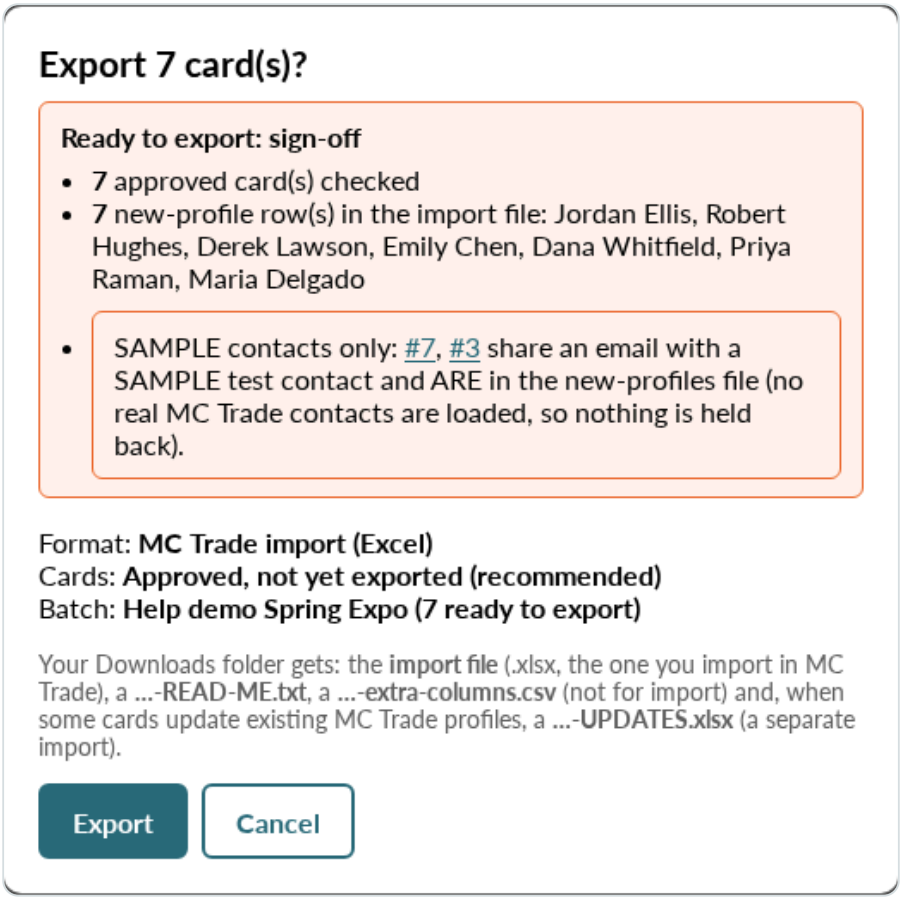
Click **Export** in the top bar. Files are saved to **this computer's Downloads folder**; nothing is uploaded anywhere.



The Export page with one batch chosen.

10.1 Export steps

1. **Which cards?** Keep **Approved, not yet exported (recommended)**. Other options: *All approved cards* (includes ones exported before); admins also see *All cards*, *Pending only* and *Rejected only*.
2. **Which batch (event)?** The list starts with **your batches** (your most recent one is chosen for you), then *other people's*. Pick your event (if there is a *Find a batch…* box, type part of the name to shorten the list). With *All batches*, look-alikes from **anyone's** batch can block the export, so choose your own batch.
3. Check the line underneath: *"7 card(s) will be exported."* If some cards were approved anyway, they are listed in red.
4. If a red **"Export is blocked"** box appears, settle each pair (section 8.3) first.
5. Click a format tile. The confirm screen is a **ready-to-export sign-off**: how many cards are approved, how many will be rows in the file (new profiles and updates counted separately), and which cards **need a decision** first, by name. Check it and click **Export**. The green message afterwards gives the same numbers as the rows in the files.



The scanner confirms format, cards and batch before exporting.

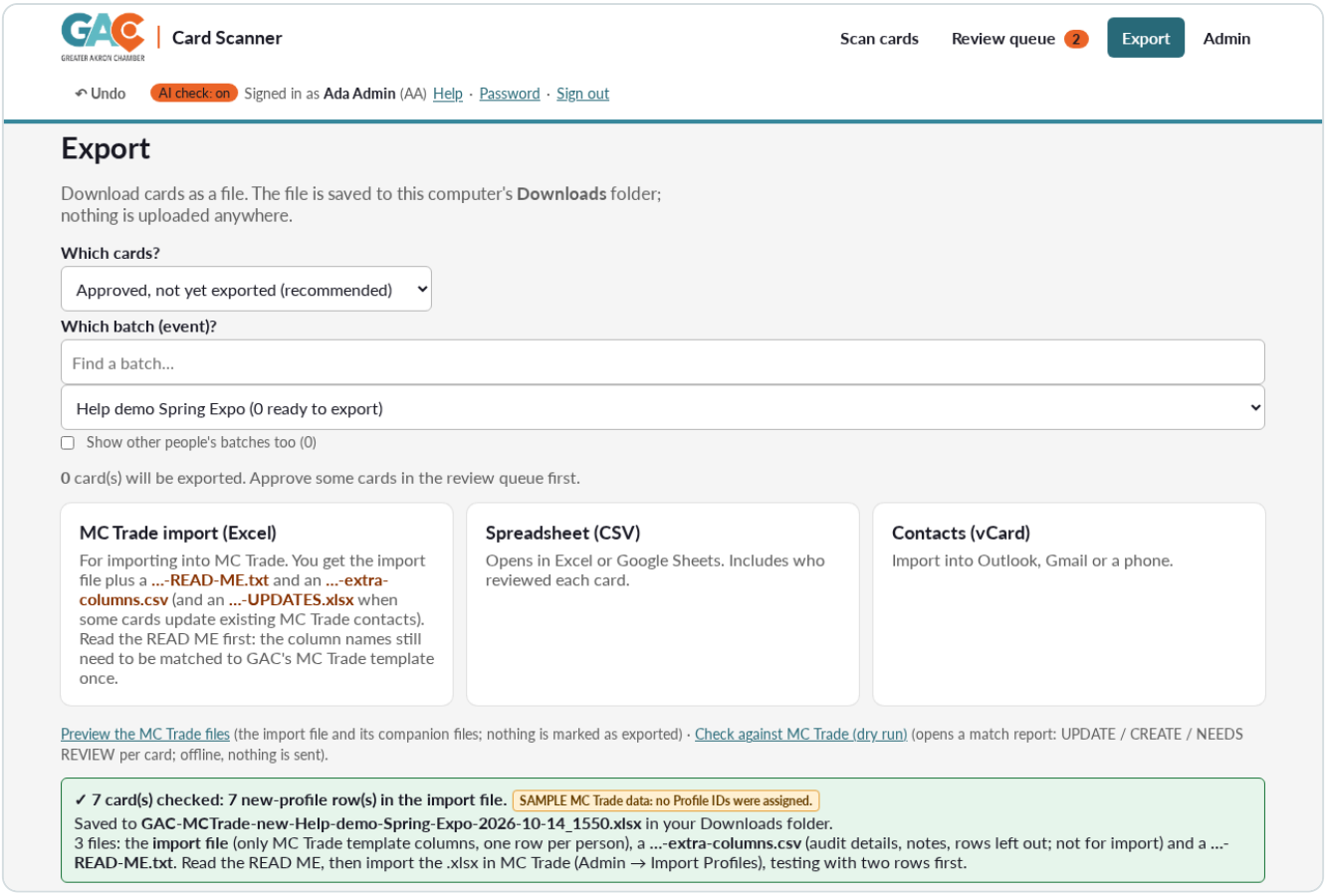
> **The export checks your sign-off.** The export uses the exact sign-off you saw. If anything changed after you opened it (a card edited, approved or rejected, the MC Trade template or the contacts file), the export is refused: *"Since you opened the export sign-off, … changed. Nothing was exported: check the sign-off again, then export."* Click the format tile again, re-check the new sign-off, and export. A script or old page that doesn't send the sign-off at all gets *"This export didn't say which sign-off it was made from… export from the Export page."* Every refusal is in the audit log with the cards it named.

After an export, those cards no longer appear under "not yet exported". If details are later merged into an exported card, it is marked **export it again** and shows up under "not yet exported" once more.

10.2 The MC Trade import (Excel) files

Clicking **MC Trade import (Excel)** downloads **three files** (four when some cards update existing contacts), named after the batch, for example `GAC-MCTrade-new-Spring-Expo-2026-10-15_1430.xlsx`:

File	What it is	Import it?
….xlsx	The import file for **new** profiles: only MC Trade template columns, one sheet, **one row per person**. Phones are written as `330-555-0181`; addresses are split into street, city, state and zip; AffCode1 is `CardScan-Pilot`.	Yes, new profiles
…-UPDATES.xlsx	Only when some cards were marked *update their existing MC Trade contact*. Has the MC Trade **ProfileID**.	Yes, as a **separate** update import
…-extra-columns.csv	Everything that isn't in the template: second email, website, credentials, department, notes, reviewer, batch, **MCTradeAction**, **NeedsAttention**, and every card that was **left out** and why (*FIX FIRST*, *same person as card #…*).	No: for checking
…-READ-ME.txt	What's in the files and what to check before importing.	No: read it first



After the export: a green confirmation. (It says "Three files"; with updates there is a fourth, the UPDATES file.)

Good to know:

- Two cards of the **same person** are combined into one row (a mobile or fax from the second card is kept). Colleagues sharing info@ stay separate, and so do people you marked as different.
- A person's **website** is in the extra-columns CSV, because Website is an organisation column in MC Trade.
- Cards with formula-like text or HTML are left out as **FIX FIRST**.
- **CHECK WEBSITE before importing: card #N...** in the READ-ME (and the on-screen preview): the website on that exported row doesn't match the email domain and came in through a merge, or looks like a phishing, login, short-link or IP address. It is only a warning; the row is still exported. Open the card, fix or clear the website, and export again if needed.
- **SAME NAME** in the READ-ME: two cards, or a card and an existing MC Trade contact, have the same first and last name. Check they are really different people before importing.
- **Phone extensions** stay in the same cell, written like `330-555-0170 x4271`. International numbers are written as `+44 20 7946 0958` in both the Excel and CSV files.
- If the READ-ME lists cards under **NEEDS REVIEW** (for example an uncertain MC Trade Profile ID), check those cards before importing.
- Admins set the **affiliation code** (AffCode1) and phone style under Admin → Settings (section 12.2).
- Until GAC's real MC Trade template is saved on the scanner computer (as `data/mctrade_template.xlsx`), the column names are the scanner's default set; the READ-ME says

"UNVERIFIED headers". Day one fixes this (section 11).

10.3 Preview the MC Trade files

Preview the MC Trade files (link under the tiles) shows the rows on screen first and lets you download them: nothing is marked as exported, and look-alikes don't block it. The preview is noted in the account log (who looked at which batch). The file names start with `PREVIEW-` and the READ-ME starts with *PREVIEW ONLY*. Use it to look at the file before the real export. **Don't import a preview** without doing the real export too, or the cards will still show as "not yet exported".

10.4 Spreadsheet (CSV) and Contacts (vCard)

- **Spreadsheet (CSV):** opens in Excel or Google Sheets, with reviewer columns and a `needs_attention` column. Cells that a spreadsheet would run as a formula get a leading `'` (plain phone numbers like `+1 330-555-0181` stay as they are).
- **Contacts (vCard):** for Outlook, Gmail or a phone's contacts.

10.5 Export history

The bottom of the Export page lists every export: when, who, format, filter, batch and number of cards. Download a copy (and its READ ME, extra columns or UPDATES file) again while it is kept (30 days by default). Only the person who exported or an admin can download a copy. **Show 10 more / Show all** see older exports.



Export history with re-download links.

> **After importing:** delete the exported files from Downloads. Treat them like any member list: don't email them outside the Chamber.

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11. MC Trade import: day-one steps

*For the first real import. One person owns the import (an MC Trade admin) and a second person double-checks. The dry run is built in: Export page → **Check against MC Trade (dry run)**. The full tick-list is `mctrade-dryrun/DAY-ONE-CHECKLIST.md`.*

Before you start

1. In MC Trade, **Admin → Manage Codes**: create the affiliation code **`CardScan-Pilot`** (exact spelling). MC Trade refuses files that use a code it doesn't have.
2. Agree with the membership lead whether event contacts come in as **Prospects** or **Neither** (MC Trade's Import screen asks Members / Prospects / Neither).

Get the real template and contacts

3. In MC Trade, **Admin → Import Profiles → Download Template Here**. Give the file to the scanner admin; it becomes the column list for the exports and the dry run.
4. In MC Trade, **Profile Selector**: search all **active Individuals → Actions → Export All System Columns** (allow pop-ups for app.atlasams.com). Save the CSV **on the scanner computer only**. Do the same for **Organizations**.
5. A scanner admin uploads that export under **Admin → Settings → MC Trade contacts** (replacing the SAMPLE list). From then on "may already be in MC Trade", the Profile IDs in the UPDATES file and the dry run all use the real contacts. **Remove** deletes it again.

Rehearse (dry run)

6. On the Export page pick your batch and click **Check against MC Trade (dry run)**. It produces a **match report** (UPDATE / CREATE / NEEDS REVIEW / LEFT OUT per card), says which contacts it used (real or SAMPLE), and is recorded in the audit log. Its decisions are **the same** as the export's files and the export sign-off: one shared rule decides all three. A card that matches an existing MC Trade contact is never put in the new-profiles file: it is NEEDS REVIEW unless it is a certain “update existing” with updates switched on, and an email shared by two MC Trade profiles is always NEEDS REVIEW.
7. In the match report, fix every **FIX FIRST** row in the scanner (blank name, bad email or phone, odd characters), merge any person who is there twice, then export and run again.
8. Work through every **NEEDS REVIEW** row: search MC Trade for the name/email, decide, and fix the card in the scanner if needed.
9. Check 5 **UPDATE** rows by hand: is it really the same person, and are the changes right? MC Trade overwrites every filled cell (blank cells don't erase anything).
10. Check 5 **CREATE** rows by searching MC Trade by last name and email.
11. **Test with 2 rows first:** keep two rows in a copy of each file, import, check the profiles, and delete those test profiles by hand if needed. **Imports can't be undone.**

Import, in this order (separate imports)

12. New **organizations** file → Organizations, new profiles.
13. New **individuals** file → Individuals, new profiles; relationship **Employer-Employee**; "Main Contact as primary" is usually **no** for event contacts. In MC Trade's duplicate checker, choose **Create new** only when you're sure it's a different person; otherwise **Ignore** the row and investigate.
14. **Updates** file → Individuals, updates. Rows match on Profile ID, so **Overwrite** is pre-selected: check it.
15. Wait for MC Trade's results email. Spot-check 10 profiles. **Profile Selector → Affiliation Code = CardScan-Pilot** lists everything that was imported.
16. **Delete** the export and import files from Downloads and the desktop. Keep only the match report in the pilot folder.

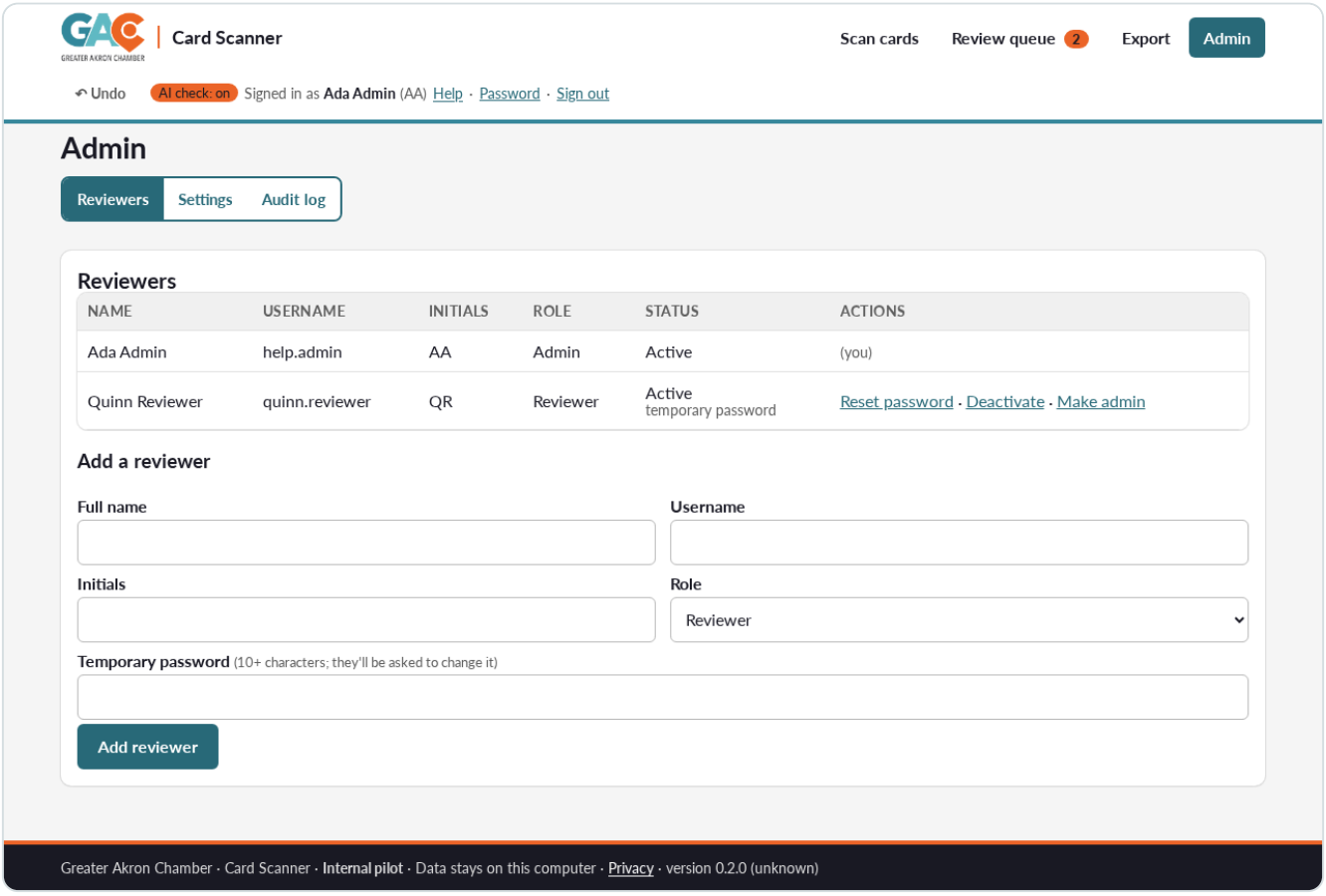
Afterwards (10 minutes): write down which template columns differed, what the real export headers are, and how many NEEDS REVIEW rows were real duplicates versus false alarms. Send the notes to the developer.

> Nothing is sent to MC Trade automatically. Live sync needs MemberClicks API credentials and is a later, developer-led step (Part C of the checklist).

12. Admin tasks

Click **Admin** in the top bar (admins only). It has three tabs: **Reviewers**, **Settings** and **Audit log**.

12.1 Reviewers (accounts)

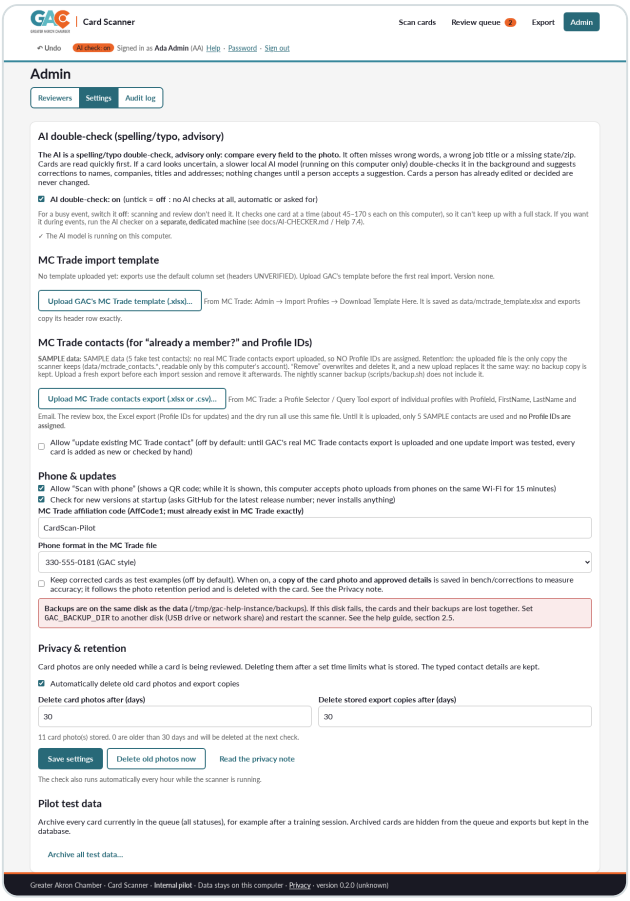


Admin → Reviewers.

- **Add a reviewer:** fill in **Full name**, **Username**, **Initials**, **Role** (Reviewer, or Admin) and a **Temporary password** (10+ characters), then click **Add reviewer**. Give the person their username and temporary password in person; they choose their own at first sign-in.
- **Reset password:** gives a new temporary password. It also **lifts a sign-in lock** after too many wrong passwords.
- **Deactivate:** for someone who left. Their past work stays in the audit log. **Reactivate** brings the account back.
- **Make admin / Make reviewer:** change the role.

Locked out (no admin can sign in): on the scanner computer, open a terminal in the scanner folder and run `.venv/bin/python -m app.admin reset-password <username>` (Mac) or `.venv\Scripts\python -m app.admin reset-password <username>` (Windows). It asks for the new password twice. `create-admin <username> "Full Name"` makes a new admin; `list` lists the accounts. Ask IT if you're not comfortable with a terminal.

12.2 Settings



Admin → Settings.

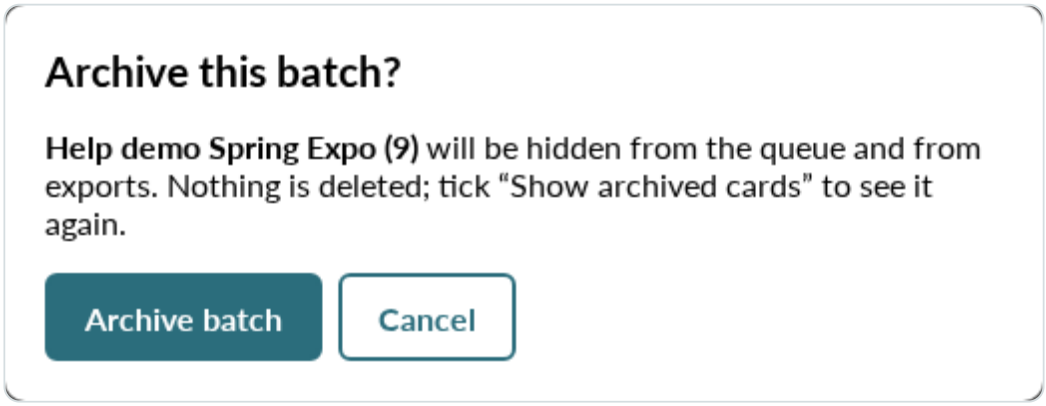
Setting	What it does
Double-check uncertain cards with the local AI model	Turns the AI double-check on or off. The line below says whether the model is running. Everyone sees the result in the header badge (*AI check: on / off*).
AI helper (desktop app only)	**Download AI helper (3 GB)**, then Start / Stop / Remove. Optional; not included in the installers.
MC Trade affiliation code (AffCode1)	Written into every row of the MC Trade file. Default `CardScan-Pilot`. It must already exist in MC Trade, spelled exactly the same.
Allow "update existing MC Trade contact"	**Off** by default. Turn on only after the real contacts export is uploaded and one update import was tested.
MC Trade template / contacts	Upload GAC's real import template and contacts export. The last 5 templates are kept; **Revert** goes back to the previous one.

Setting	What it does
Phone format in the MC Trade file	`330-555-0181` (GAC style, default) or `+13305550181`.
Keep corrected cards as test examples	**Off** by default. When on, a copy of the photo and approved details of each corrected card is kept (bench/corrections) to measure accuracy. See the Privacy note before turning it on.
Automatically delete old card photos and export copies	Retention on/off.
Delete card photos after (days)	Default **30**. Must be 1 to 3650. Photos of cards that are still **pending** are never deleted. The line below says how many photos are stored and how many will go at the next check.
Delete stored export copies after (days)	Default **30**.

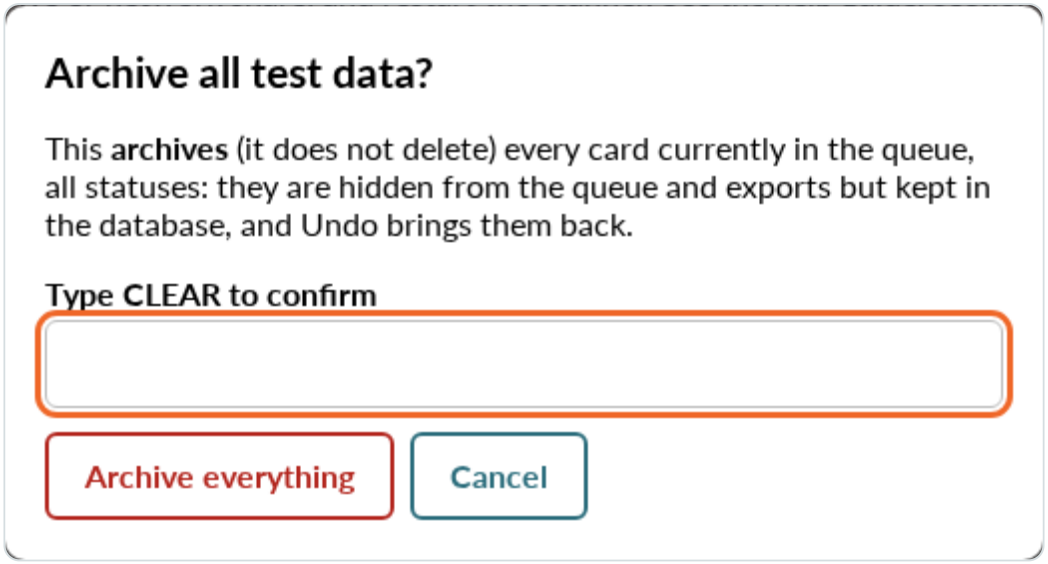
Click **Save settings** after changing anything. **Delete old photos now** runs the clean-up straight away (it also runs every hour). The typed contact details are kept; only photos (and their thumbnails) are deleted. A card whose photo was deleted shows **Photo deleted**.

12.3 Archiving test data and finished batches

- **Archive one batch:** Review queue → choose the batch → **Archive this batch** → confirm. The batch is hidden from the queue and from exports. Nothing is deleted: tick **Show archived cards** to see it again, and **Undo** brings it back.
- **Archive all test data** (for example after a training session): Admin → Settings → **Pilot test data → Archive all test data…**, type **CLEAR** in capitals, and confirm. Every card in the queue (all statuses) is archived, not deleted.



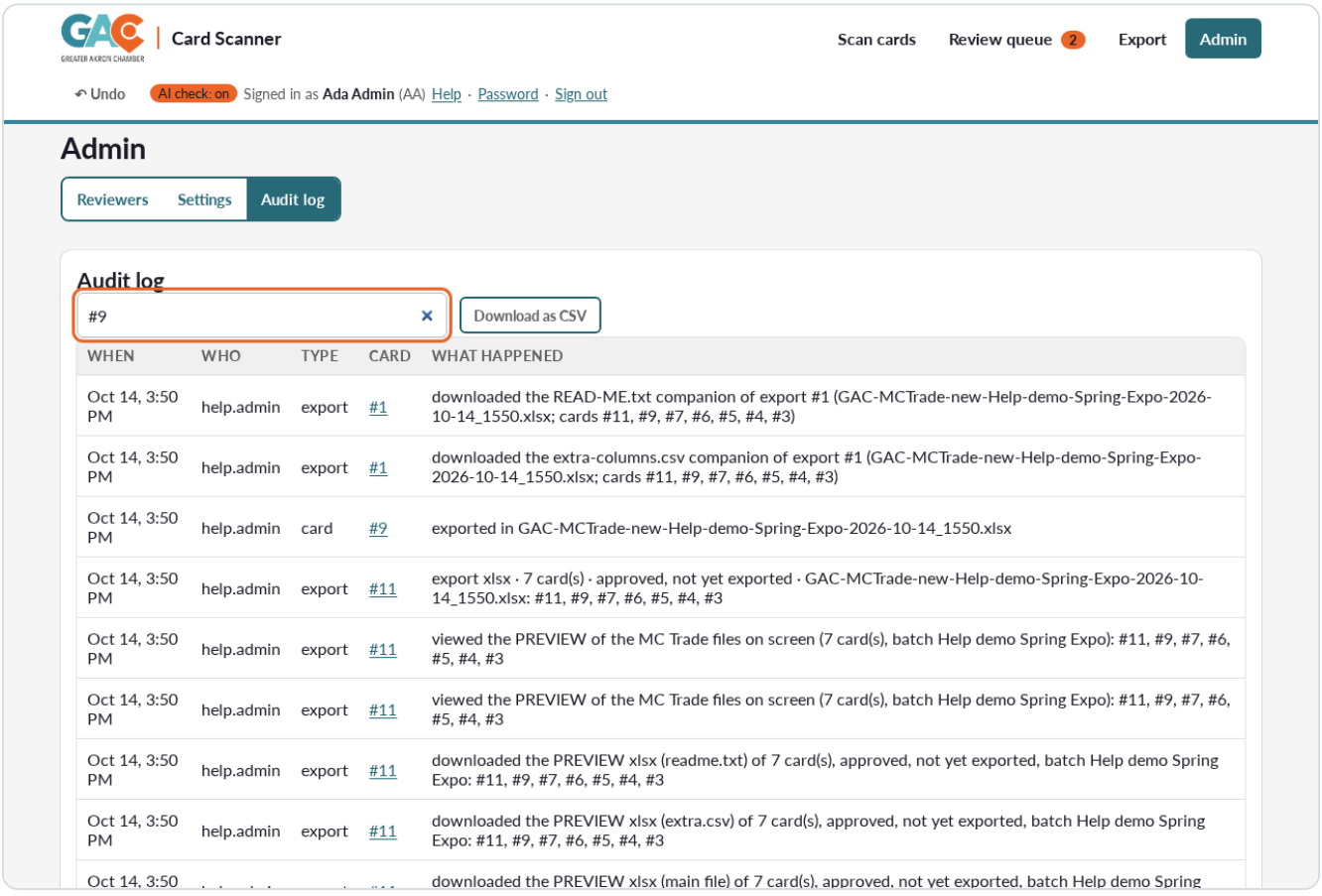
Archive this batch: hidden, not deleted.



Archive all test data needs CLEAR typed in capitals.

12.4 Audit log

Admin → Audit log lists every sign-in and failed sign-in, decision, edit, merge, export, re-download, undo, setting change (only what changed, e.g. *"AI double-check: on → off"*), photo deletion and permanent deletion, with who and when. Search it (initials, **#17** for a card, *export*, *login*…) or click **Download as CSV**.



The audit log searched for one card.

13. Privacy and removal requests

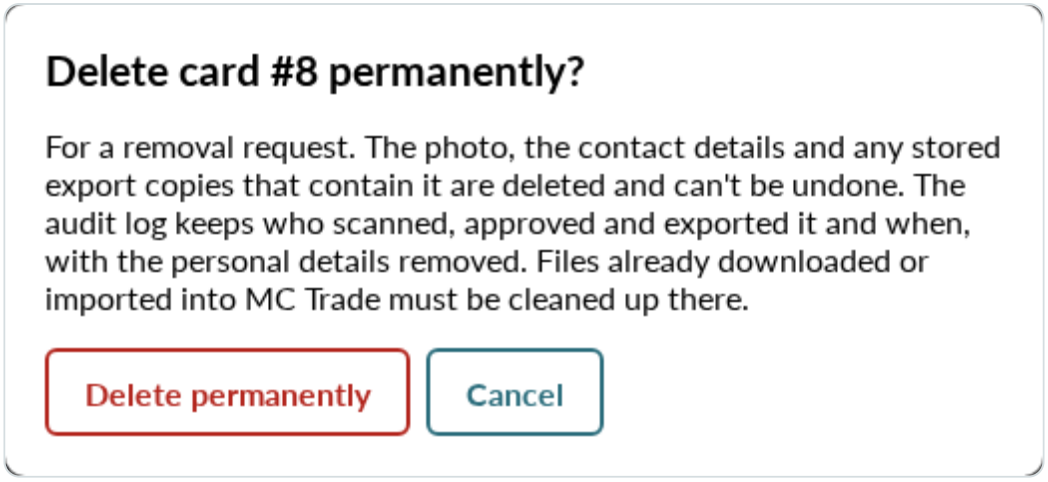
What is kept: a photo of each card, the details printed on it, any note, who scanned/edited/approved/exported it and when, and staff sign-ins (including the computer's network address). Everything stays on the scanner computer, in its `data` folder.

What	How long
Card photos (and their small thumbnails)	Deleted after **30 days** (admins can change this); never while the card is pending
Stored copies of exports (for re-download)	Deleted after **30 days**
"Undo" copies of card details	Cleared after **2 days**
Typed contact details	Kept (they become Chamber contact records); archive a batch or delete a card permanently
Audit log and sign-ins	Kept for accountability; personal details are removed from a card's rows after a removal request
Test examples	Off by default (see Settings)

Read the full **Privacy** note from the link at the bottom of every page.

13.1 When someone asks to be removed (admins)

1. In the **Review queue**, choose the **All** tab and search the person's name or email. Open the card.
2. Click **Delete permanently…** and confirm with **Delete permanently**. This erases the photo, the details, any test-example copy and any stored export copies that contain the card. It **can't be undone**. The audit log keeps who scanned, approved and exported the card and when, with the personal details removed.
3. Repeat for any other card of the same person (search again).
4. Remove the person from **MC Trade** as well, and delete any exported spreadsheets that contain them.
5. Note the request in your usual records.



Delete permanently is for removal requests only. Cancel is the default.

Good practice: turn on disk encryption on the scanner computer (BitLocker / FileVault), use phone access only on the office Wi-Fi, and deactivate accounts of staff who leave.

14. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to do
Browser says **"can't connect"** / "This site can't be reached"	The black scanner window was closed, or the computer restarted. Double-click **start** again.
A batch row says **"Connection to the scanner was lost"**	Same as above: restart the scanner, then add the photos that weren't finished again.
"Lost track of this upload (the scanner was restarted)"	Add that photo again.
Every card fails to scan	Tesseract isn't installed. The black window says so. See section 2.1, step 2.
The header shows **"AI: N cards · all done in ~M min"**	That is the optional AI double-check line (a separate, later step, everyone's cards). Your cards are already in the Review queue: review them now. See 7.1.
The Review queue badge shows **"3 · 2 more being read"**	3 of *your* cards are pending; 2 more of your photos are still being read. Hover it for the counts from everyone.
"This save didn't say which version of the card it was made from" or **"Card #N changed since you opened it… Nothing was saved"** (409)	Someone else, another tab or the AI changed the card. Your typed values stay on the form: note them, **reload the card**, check it, and save again.
"…didn't say which version … it was made from … Nothing was changed: reload Admin → Settings" (428)	An old Admin page (or a script) tried to save settings, a template or contacts without the version it showed. Reload Admin → Settings and make the change again.
"Since you opened the export sign-off, … changed. Nothing was exported" (409)	Re-check: click the format tile again, read the new sign-off, then export (section 10.1).

Problem	What to do
"This export didn't say which sign-off it was made from" (428)	Export from the Export page (format tile → sign-off → Export), not from a saved link or script.
"Another admin changed … after you opened this page"	Two admins edited Settings (contacts file, "update existing" switch, template) at the same time. Nothing was saved: reload Admin → Settings, check their change, then try again.
"Another export of these cards is running right now"	Someone (maybe you, in another tab) is already exporting this batch. Wait, then check the export history before exporting again.
"This save would clear …"	The card hadn't finished loading when Save was clicked. Wait until the form shows the card, then save again.
Scanning is **slow**	Normal when several people scan at once (5–30 s per card). Leave the batch running and review finished cards.
"AI checker OFFLINE" in the black window, or *"The AI model is not running right now"* in Settings	Scanning still works. Start `start-ai-checker.command` if IT installed the model (section 7.5).
A card says **AI busy** or **AI checking…** for a long time	You don't need to wait: review and approve the card. After 30 minutes the check is skipped.
"Saving your previous change first…"	You clicked Save or Approve while the last save was still on its way. Wait a moment: the scanner saves what is on the form once the first save finishes. If it can't, you see **"Not saved"** and your typed values stay on the form. A save never disappears without a message.
"This card is archived, so it can't be changed"	Archived cards are read-only. An admin can un-archive the batch if it needs more work.
Bulk approve asks one question	The one dialog lists the cards that will be skipped (and why, field by field), the cards whose AI check hasn't finished, and any look-alikes approved in another batch. Choose to approve all of them, or to leave the look-alikes pending.
Fields are **greyed out** and won't take typing	The card is still loading. Wait a second.
The counter says **"· 0 pending left"**	Every card in this batch has been decided. Go to Export, or pick another batch.
"May be the same person as card #N (rejected, this batch)"	Only a hint: the twin was rejected. Check the right card was kept, then approve.
Approve does nothing / shows a list of problems	Fix the listed fields (Reviewer guide, section 5). A blank first name, email without "@" or short phone can't be approved anyway.
Bulk approve **skipped** some cards	They need fixing or have a duplicate question. Open each listed card.
Export is blocked	Two cards in the export look like the same person. Use the buttons in the red box, or pick your own batch (section 8.3).
"0 card(s) will be exported"	Nothing approved and not yet exported in that batch. Check the batch, or choose *All approved cards*.

Problem	What to do
A photo is **"already scanned"**	It's the same photo as an earlier card in the same batch. Open that card, or click **Scan it anyway** if you really want a copy.
The folder button doesn't open	Use **Choose photos** and select all (Ctrl+A / ⌘A), or drag the folder onto the box.
"Please sign in" keeps appearing	Your session expired (12 hours), or an admin reset your password. Sign in again.
Red warning **"signed in as a different person"**	Someone else signed in in this browser. Reload, check whose name is in the top bar, and sign in as yourself.
Can't sign in after wrong passwords	Wait 5 minutes, or ask an admin to reset your password.
No admin can sign in	See *Locked out* in section 12.1.
A message **"Restored the edits you hadn't saved…"**	You were signed out with unsaved edits. Check them and save.
Photo shows **"Photo deleted"**	The retention setting removed it. The contact details are still there.
The phone shows **"connection is not private"**	Expected with phone access; see section 2.4, step 4.
The phone can't open the address	It must be on the **same office Wi-Fi**, and phone access must be on (the black window says *Phone access is ON*).
Something else looks wrong	Take a screenshot, note the card number (#), and tell the scanner admin.

15. Frequently asked questions

Does anything go to MC Trade automatically? No. You export a file and an MC Trade admin imports it. Live sync is a possible later step.

Does anything go to the internet or an AI company? No. Reading, the AI double-check and duplicate checks all run on the scanner computer.

Do I have to wait for the AI double-check before approving? No. If a check is still waiting, Approve asks whether to cancel it. If suggestions arrive after you approved, the card isn't changed.

What if I leave a card without saving? The scanner asks before you leave (Queue link, next card, sign-out). What you typed is also kept as a draft on this computer and comes back when you open the card again; **Save** clears it.

When does a card say "Looks good"? Only when name, company, email and website are filled in and nothing needs a second look. A card with a blank required field or a hint says **Check**.

What does "Check" mean on a new card? Something needs a second look on the review screen, for example a hard-to-read field or a possible duplicate. "Looks good" cards still need reviewing.

How do I say two look-alike cards are different people? On the card, choose **Different person from all N listed cards: keep both** in *Your decision for this card* and click **Save decision**. It settles every look-alike listed there in one click and is recorded. It isn't offered for a duplicate scan (same email or phone in the same batch): merge or reject one of those.

Why can't I approve a card with a formula-like value such as `=SUM(1)`? Spreadsheets could run it as a formula when the file is opened. Fix the field (for example remove the leading `=`).

Someone gave me their card at two events. What do I do? Open the second card, choose **Same person as #X …: add any new details to #X and drop this card** and click **Save decision**. Their new details are added to the first card.

The person is already in MC Trade. What should I choose? Same person: update their existing MC Trade contact. The card goes into the UPDATES file instead of creating a new profile.

I approved the wrong card. Can I fix it? Press **U** or click **↶ Undo** (your own actions, last 24 hours), or open the card and click **Move back to pending**.

I exported, then fixed a card. Does it go out again? If details were merged into an exported card, it's marked *export it again* and appears under "Approved, not yet exported". For other edits, export *All approved cards* for that batch, or ask the importer to fix it in MC Trade.

What's the Preview link on the Export page for? To look at the MC Trade Excel file without marking anything as exported.

Which file do I import into MC Trade? The `.xlsx` for new profiles, and the `-UPDATES.xlsx` as a separate update import. Never the `-extra-columns.csv` or `-READ-ME.txt`. For the first real import, follow section 11.

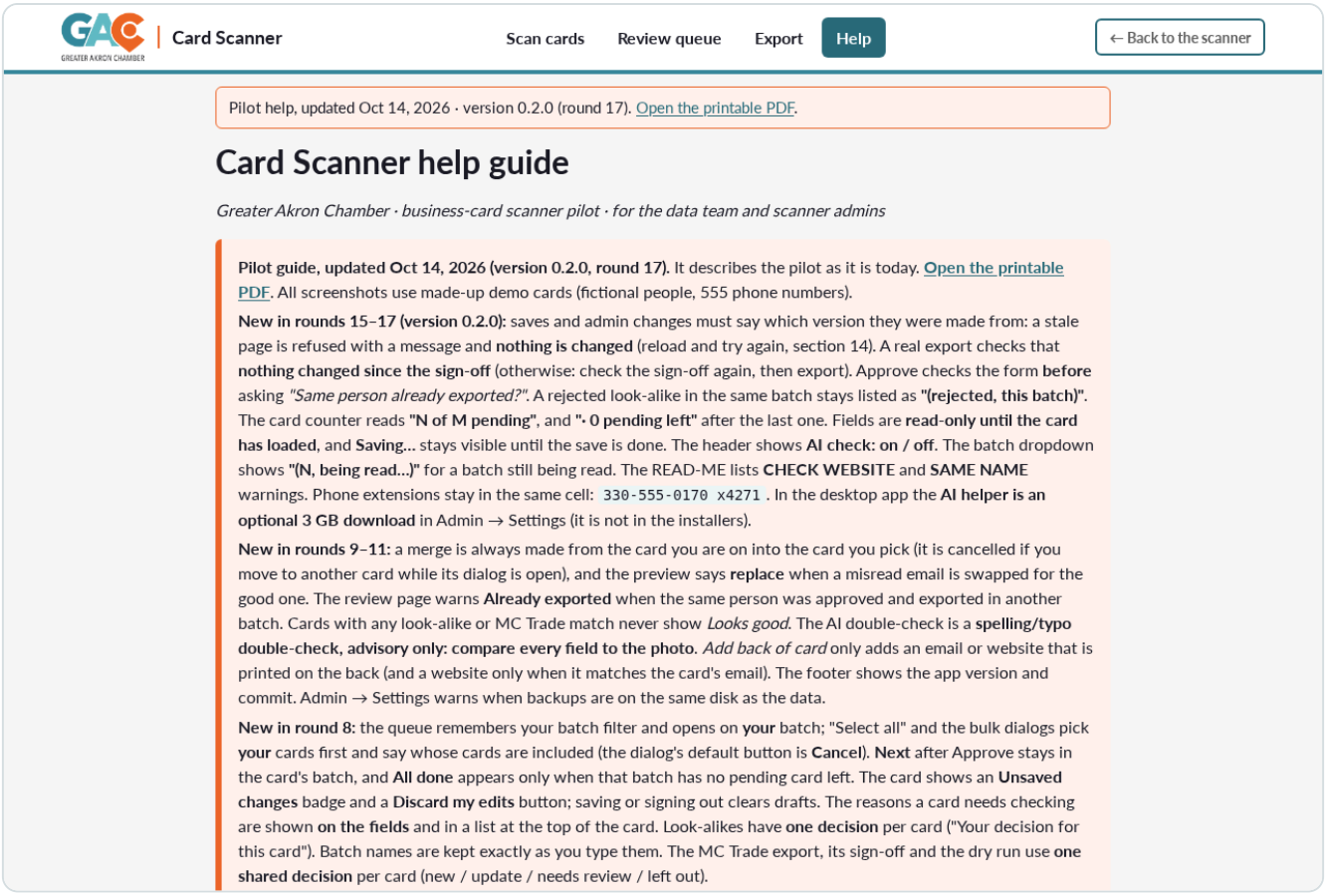
Can I use the scanner on my phone? Yes, once phone access is turned on (section 2.4), on the office Wi-Fi only.

How long are card photos kept? 30 days by default (never while the card is pending). The typed details are kept.

Can I delete a whole batch? Admins can **archive** a batch (hidden, not deleted). Permanent deletion is per card, for removal requests.

Who can see what I did? Admins, in the audit log. Your initials are also on every card you edit, approve or export, and in exports.

Where can I find this guide in the app? Click **Help** in the top bar (next to *Password*). It opens in a new tab.



The in-app help page.

16. Quick reference

I want to…	Go to
Scan an event's cards	**Scan cards** → name the batch → drag photos in
Review cards	**Review queue** → pick the batch → open a card
Approve / reject quickly	**A** / **R** (after **Esc**), **J** / **K** next/previous, **U** undo
See only problem cards	Review queue → **Needs attention only**
Export for MC Trade	**Export** → Approved, not yet exported → your batch → **MC Trade import (Excel)**
Look at the MC Trade files first	Export → **Preview the MC Trade files**
Add a team member	**Admin → Reviewers → Add a reviewer**
Unlock someone	**Admin → Reviewers → Reset password**
Change photo retention	**Admin → Settings → Privacy & retention**
Hide a finished/test batch	Review queue → choose batch → **Archive this batch**

I want to…	Go to
Handle a removal request	Find the card → **Delete permanently…** (admins)
See who did what	**Admin → Audit log**

Questions about this guide: talk to the scanner admin. Source documents: QUICKSTART.md, DATA-TEAM-GUIDE.md, PRIVACY-NOTE.md, mctrade-dryrun/DAY-ONE-CHECKLIST.md.